CHAP. V.

Of MORAL EVIL.

INTRODUCTION,

Containing the Substance of the Chapter.

HAVING given some Account of *Natural Evils*, the *Moral* come next under Consideration: we are now to trace out the Origin of these, and see of what kind it is, whether they flow from the same Source with the Natural, *viz*. the necessary *Imperfection* of created Beings; or we are to seek for some other entirely different from it.

By *Moral* Evils, as we said before, are understood those Inconveniencies of Life and Condition which befall ourselves or others through wrong Election. For it is plain that some Inconveniencies happen without our Knowledge, or against our Wills, by the very Order of natural Causes; whereas others come upon us knowingly, and in a manner with our Consent (when we choose either these themselves, or such as are necessarily connected with them.) The Moral are to be reckon'd among the latter kind of Inconveniencies: and he must esteem'd the Cause of them, who knowingly, and of his own accord, brings them either upon himself or others by a depraved or foolish Choice.

But in order to make this whole Matter concerning Moral Evils more fully understood, we must consider in the 1st Place, *What the Nature of Election is*. 2dly, *That our Happiness chiefly depends upon Elections*. 3dly, *What kind of Elections may be said to be made amiss, or* foolishly. 4thly, *How we come to fall into depraved or* wicked *Elections*. 5thly, *How such Elections can be reconciled with the Power and Goodness of God*.

SECT. I.

Concerning the Nature of Elections.

SUBSECT. I.

A View of their Opinion, who admit of Freedom from Compulsion only, but not from Necessity.

That it is not easy to understand or give a true representation of the Opinions concerning Liberty. Some knowledge a Liberty from Compulsion only, others from Necessity also.

I. IF there be any thing obscure and difficult in Philosophy, we are sure to find it in that Part which treats of Elections and Liberty. There is no Point about which the Learned are less consistent with themselves, or more divided from each other. Nor is it an easy Matter to understand them, or to give a certain and true representation of their Opinions. I think they may be distinguish'd into two Sects, both admitting of Liberty, the one from external *Compulsion*, but not from internal *Necessity*; the other from both.

The Authors of the former Opinion suppose Appetites implanted in us by Nature; what is agreeable to these is called good; the contrary, Evil.

II. As far as I can understand the Opinion of the former, it is this: First, they observe that there are certain *Appetites* implanted in us by Nature, which are not to be esteem'd *useless*, but contributing toward our Preservation, as was shewn before; and that some things are naturally agreeable, some contrary to these Appetites: that the *former*, when present, please and impress a delightful Sense of themselves; the *latter* displease and create uneasiness. These therefore are called incommodious, troublesome and Evil; and those commodious, convenient and Good.

Things are agreeable to the Appetites in a threefold respect. Hence three kinds of good.

III. Secondly, That Nature has given us *Reason*, a *Mind* or *Intellect*, to distinguish Conveniencies from Inconveniencies, Good from Evil. And since this may be considered by the Mind in a threefold Respect, hence also arise three kinds of Good and Evil; namely *Pleasant*, *Profitable* and *Honest*.

That which is actually agreeable is called Pleasant.

IV. For if Good be considered as present with regard only to the Appetite which is delighted with the Enjoyment of it, and acquiesces in it, 'tis called *Pleasant*.

That which is connected with something which is of itself agreeable, is called Profitable.

V. If it be not agreeable to the Appetite of itself, but only *connected* with something else which is of itself agreeable, or produces Pleasure, and on that account only desirable; then 'tis called *Profitable*. For though the Appetite cannot come at the immediate Enjoyment of it, yet the Mind makes use of it in order to procure those things which it can enjoy, and from thence it is esteem'd *convenient*, *i. e*. Good.

That which is judged by the Understanding to be the best, all things considered, is absolutely good, and called Honest.

VI. But since that which is agreeable to one Appetite, may be repugnant or less agreeable to others; and that which pleases now, may have some things connected with it which may be displeasing afterwards, there is need of enquiry and deliberation, to procure an absolute Good, *i. e.* one which, all Appetites and Times considered, will afford as great, as certain and durable a Pleasure or Delight as possible. For this End therefore was the Mind or Understanding given us, that we might be able to determine what appears fittest to be done upon a view of all such things as create Pleasure or uneasiness for the present or the future. And what is thus judg'd by the Understanding to be the best, if there be no Error in the Case, must be look'd upon as *Honest*. For that is *Honest* which is agreeable to a rational Agent; but it is agreeable to a rational Agent, and Reason itself directs, that, all things consider'd, we should prefer that which brings the greater, the more certain and more durable Advantages.

Instances in Health, Medicines, and such things as are agreeable to the Rational Appetite.

VII. The Defenders of this Opinion reckon these kinds of Good to be *Moral*, so far as they respect Man, because they fall under the Government of Reason. But since all things

cannot be always had together, a comparison must be made between them, and that embraced which appears to be the best. Now the kinds may be compared together, as well as the particulars of each kind. For instance, Health is a things pleasant in itself, and desirable above all things that relate to the Body; but for the preservation of it Medicines must be sometimes taken, which of themselves are far from being agreeable to the Appetite, but as they are means to an End which in itself is delightful, they are said to be profitable, and on that account fit to be chosen. Now the Goods of the Mind are greater, more certain and more durable than those of the Body; if therefore they cannot be had without the loss of Health, or even Life, right Reason dictates, that Health, or even Life be despised in regard to these. For this appears to be the most convenient, all things consider'd, and on that account is *honest:* and as Goods of a different kind may be compared together, so may also particulars of the same kind, as any one will find that considers it.

He that can act as his own Judgment directs, is free according to these Men.

VIII. As to *Liberty*, the Men of this Sect will have it to consist in this, that among all those Goods, an Agent can embrace that which pleases him best, and exert those Actions which his own Reason approves: For, according to these Men, he that can follow his own *Judgment* in Matters is free. For Example, he that is sound in Body, and has his Faculties and Limbs entire, if all external Impediments be removed, is at Liberty to walk: for he can if he *will*, and nothing but his will is wanting to exert that Action.

But we are determin'd to choose either from the goodness or disagreeableness of objects perceiv'd by the Intellect or Senses; and therefore not free as to the Acts of the Will, but only of the inferior Faculties, which are subject to its determination.

IX. But as to the Actions of the *Will* itself, namely, to *will*, or to *suspend* the Act of Volition, they think that it is determined to these, not by itself, for that is impossible; but from without. If you ask from whence? They answer, from the *Pleasure* or *Uneasiness* perceived by the Understanding or the Senses; but rather, as they imagine, from the present or most urgent *Uneasiness:* since therefore these are produced in us *ab extra*, not from the Will itself, and are not in its power, but arise from the very things; 'tis manifest, according to these Men, that we are not free (at least from *Necessity*) to *will* or *not* will, that is, with regard to the immediate Acts of the Will. Some of them therefore expresly deny, that *Liberty* belongs to Man with regard to these Acts, or that an Election can be said to be free, or Man himself in that Respect: They will have it therefore, that *Liberty* belongs to us properly with respect to the *inferior* Faculties, which are subject to the Government of the Will, and discharge their Functions when the Man himself has willed: that is, a Man is free to walk who can walk if he pleases; but not to will; for he receives the Will to walk from elsewhere: nevertheless, he that can *do* what he wills, according to them, is free, even tho' he be necessarily determin'd to will.

If this be so, all our Actions are absolutely necessary.

X. If it be granted that this is the Nature of our Elections, there is no doubt but all our Actions are really and truly necessary. For as to the proper Actions of the Will, to will or suspend the Act of Volition, the Men whom we are speaking of, give up Liberty with respect to these, while they assert that it does not belong to them. For they are of Opinion that when any thing is proposed by the Understanding to be done, we either will it, or suspend the Act of Volition concerning it, according to the prospect of Happiness or importunity of the Uneasiness which appears to the Mind, in the present State and Circumstances; by these therefore our Election, according to them, is determin'd.

That human Actions are free, not from Necessity, but Compulsion.

XI. But when the Election is made, if we can effect what we will, then they say we are free in respect of such Actions, not from Necessity, but only from Compulsion; for it is plain that nothing but our will is wanting to the exertion of them, and supposing us to will them, they necessarily follow. For instance, when nothing hinders a Man from walking but his own Will, supposing this Volition, it cannot be conceiv'd but that he must walk, nor can he rest while this continues. If therefore, according to them, all acts of the Will are necessary (as being determin'd from without, *viz*. by the convenience or inconvenience of things or circumstances) the actions of the inferior faculties will be no less necessary, for they will depend on the same circumstances and acts of the Will, which, as they are necessary, these actions will be necessary also. Though, according to them, therefore, there be no *Compulsion* of the Will, yet there is *Necessity*, from which Necessity nothing in the World will be free; nay, a great many of them openly profess to believe that this is the Case.

According to their Opinion there is no *contingency* in things, nor could any thing be done otherwise than it is.

XII. Now, from this Hypothesis, which they extend to the Divine as well as Human Will, the following Corollaries seem deducible. First, that nothing in Nature could be done otherwise than it is. For, the whole Series of things being as it were connected together by Fate, there's no Room for Chance or Liberty, properly so called: *Contingency* then is removed out of Nature.

By Evil they understand nothing more than hurtful.

XIII. Secondly, That nothing more can be understood by wicked or wrong made Elections, than that they are prejudicial to the Elector or some others; which Sense is very remote from the vulgar one; for in that Evil Elections are blamed, not for being hurtful, but for being hurtful without Necessity, and because they are made otherwise than they ought to have been: In this Hypothesis then there is no Election made amiss. Nor can any thing be said to be done otherwise than it ought to be: for what could not possibly be done otherwise, is certainly done as it ought; since it is done according to the exigence and necessary order of things.

Villanies are to be placed to the account of human Misery, and not looked upon as Crimes, properly so called.

XIV. Thirdly, By the same Principle all Evil wou'd be in the strictest sense *Natural*, for it would derive its Origin from natural and necessary Causes. The distinction then would be lost between natural and moral Evil, as commonly understood. There would be no Moral Evil at all. For that only is reckoned Moral by the common consent of Mankind, of which the Man himself is properly the Cause: but no body looks upon himself as properly the Cause of a thing which he could not avoid, or to which he was necessitated by natural Causes, and such as were antecedent to the Will. For every one blames himself only on this account, because he was of himself unnecessarily the Cause of Evil to himself or others. Those Inconveniencies which come by Necessity, he looks upon as Miseries, as Misfortunes, but never as a Crime. Thefts therefore, Adulteries, Perjuries, nay the Hatred of

God himself, and whatever we esteem base in Villanies (as well as the disgrace and punishment attending them) must be placed to the account of human Misery and Unhappiness, but by no means reckoned criminal, nor any more repugnant to the Will of God, to his Justice, Purity or Goodness, than Heat or Cold.

A Malefactor is reproved, not because he deserved it, but because reproof may drive him from Evil.

XV. Fourthly, When therefore we blame a Thief, Adulterer, Murderer, or perjured Person, when those Crimes are arraigned as scandalous; this is not done because they have deserved it, or because these things are in themselves really shameful or culpable; but because that Infamy may be a means of deterring the guilty Persons or others from the like Elections. And this is the only Reason why we reproach a Thief, &*c*. and not a sick Person, with Infamy; because Reproach may cure a Thief, &*c*. but can do no Good to a sick Person.

Punishments are applyed as Medicines to the Sick; neither are Laws useless, since they prevent Vice.

XVI. Fifthly, Malefactors are punished not because they deserve Punishment, but because it is expedient, and Laws are used to restrain Vices, as Physic to remove Diseases; Men sin therefore after the same manner as they die, *viz*. because an effectual Remedy was not applyed. And yet Laws are not entirely useless, since they prevent some Vices, as Medicines protract the Deaths of some diseased Persons: and a Person infected with the Plague may be as justly cut off by the Law, as a Witch, when by that means there's hope of avoiding the Contagion.

We are obliged to be grateful only in prospect of a future Benefit.

XVII. Sixthly, We are obliged to repay good Offices, since by being thankful we may excite the Benefactor to continue or increase his Benevolence, and also induce others to do us Service. And hence it comes to pass, that we are obliged to be grateful towards God and Men, but not to the Sun or a Horse, because God and men may be excited by thanks to some farther Beneficence, whereas the Sun or a Horse cannot. Thus no regard is to be had to a Benefit received, but only to one that may be received; nor are we obliged to be grateful to the most generous Benefactor for what is past, but only for the prospect of what is to come. All sense of gratitude then, as commonly understood, is destroyed; for the Vulgar reckon him a cunning, not a grateful Person, who returns one favour merely out of hopes of another.

According to this Opinion, human Happiness is impossible, since it depends upon things which are not in our Power.

XVIII. Seventhly, If this Opinion be true, we must despair of human Felicity, which will not in the least be in our own Power, but entirely depend upon external Objects. Our happiness (if there be any) must, according to them, be conceived to arise from the perfect enjoyment of those things which are agreeable to the Appetites. Where the contrary to these are present, or the agreeable ones absent, we must necessarily be uneasy, and while we struggle with Anxieties we cannot be happy. According to this Hypothesis therefore it follows, that our Happiness necessarily requires such an Enjoyment as we have spoken of, and that is at the same time impossible. For who can hope that all external things (with which he has to do) should be so tempered as in every respect to answer his Wishes so as never to want what he desires, or to be forced to endure any thing contrary to his natural Appetites? If Happiness arises from the Enjoyment of those things which are agreeable to the Faculties and Appetites, and which can move Desire by their innate, or at least apparent Goodness; if also the Will is necessarily determined to these, according to the Judgment of the Understanding, or Importunity of Appetites, every man must necessarily want a great many things which he has chosen, and bear a great many which he would not, than which nothing is more inconsistent with Felicity. For we cannot possibly conceive any State of Life wherein all things answer to the natural Appetites. In vain then do we hope for Happiness, if it depend upon external Objects.

Its consequences hard, and tho' the Argument from consequences be generally a bad one, yet these bring some prejudice against an Opinion which seems attended with them, especially if they be acknowledged.

XIX. This, and a great deal more that might be added, must seem hard and repugnant to the common Notions of Men, and cannot be believed without extraordinary Prejudice to Mankind. I confess indeed that, for the most part, one cannot argue well against an opinion from its consequences, since a great many things are true which have consequences hard enough: not to mention how easily we mistake in deducing consequences. But yet when these are acknowledged by the Authors themselves; and, if believed, would prove detrimental to Morality, they bring no small prejudice against an Opinion which is attended with them, and recommend us to some other as more probable, tho' it be not supported by any stronger Reasons.

All those who declare that the Will is passive in its Operations must be of the same Opinion with the former, and pressed with the same consequences.

XX. 'Tis to be observed also, that among the foregoing Authors I reckon those who declare that the Will is determined by the last Judgment of the Understanding, which has taken with a great many Philosophers; and in short, all who maintain that the Will is *passive* in Elections. For these must be esteemed to have the same Sentiments of Liberty with the former, which way soever they explain their Opinion; as may appear from hence, that most of them expressly deny that *Indifference* belongs to the Nature of Freedom; so that their Opinion is attended with the same consequences as the former.

SUBSECT. II.

An Opinion is proposed in general, asserting a Freedom from Necessity as well as Compulsion.

This agrees with the former in most cases, especially in those relating to the Appetites, to Good, Pleasant, Profitable and Honest: but makes this to be the difference between a Man and Brute, *viz*. that the one is determined by its bodily Appetite, the other by himself.

I. THIS Opinion determines almost the same with the former concerning the Goodness or Agreeableness of Objects to the Appetites, nor is there much difference in what relates to the distinction of Good into Pleasant, Profitable, and Honest: Except that it refers Honest to the Duty which a Man owes to God, himself, and other Men, as a Member of an intelligent Society, rather than to the natural Appetites; and thinks that we

are to judge of the Agreeableness of things from that, rather than from these. As to the Election which the Will makes on account of these, it asserts that this proceeds from the Will itself, and that a free Agent cannot be determin'd like natural Bodies by external Impulses, or like Brutes by Objects. For this is the very difference betwixt Man and the Brutes, that these are determin'd according to their bodily Appetites, whence all their Actions are necessary, but Man has a different Principle in him, and determines himself to Action.

That the chief Good is necessarily desir'd, but others are not, because they may be represented by the Understanding in different respects.

II. This Principle whereby Man excells the Brutes in thus explain'd by the Defenders of the following Opinion, if I take their Meaning right: In the first place, they declare that there is some *Chief Good*, the Enjoyment of which would make a Man compleatly happy; this he naturally and necessarily desires, and cannot reject it when duly represented by the Understanding. That other things which offer themselves have a Relation to this Good, or some Connection with it, and are to be esteem'd Good or Evil, as they help or hinder our obtaining it; and since there is nothing in Nature but what in some respect or other, either promotes this End, or prevents it; from this Indifference they declare, that we have an Opportunity of rejecting or receiving any thing. For though we can choose nothing but under the Appearance of Good, *i. e.* unless it be in some manner connected with the Chief Good, as a Means or Appendage; yet this does not determine the Choice, because every Object may be varied, and represented by the Understanding under very different Appearances.

Though therefore the Will follows some Judgment of the Understanding, yet it is not necessarily determin'd by it.

III. Secondly, When therefore any Good is proposed which is not the Chief, the Will can *suspend* the Action, and command the Understanding to propose some other thing, or the same in some different view: which may be always done, since every thing except the chief Good is of such a Nature, that the Understanding may apprehend some respect or relation wherein it is incommodious. Notwithstanding therefore that the Will always does follow some Judgment of the Understanding, which is made about the subsequent Actions, yet it is not necessarily determin'd by any, for it can suspend its Act, and order some other Judgment, which it may follow. Since therefore it can either exert or suspend its Act, it is not only free from Compulsion, but also indifferent in itself, with regard to its Actions, and determines itself without necessity.

This Opinion establishes Liberty, but yet there are some things not sufficiently explained in it.

IV. It must be confess'd, that this Opinion does establish Liberty, and on that account is more agreeable to reason, experience, and the common sense of Mankind, yet some things in it seem to be presum'd upon and not sufficiently explain'd.

Such a Liberty as this seems to be of more prejudice than benefit to Mankind.

V. For in the first place, 'tis said that the Will *determines itself*, but we are not inform'd how that is possible, nor what use such a Power would be of, were it admitted: nay, it seems rather prejudicial than advantageous to Mankind. For that Goodness which it is supposed to pursue, is in the things themselves, and arises from their connection with the chief Good; it is not therefore to be form'd, but discovered by the Understanding. If then the Understanding performs its Duty right, it will discover what is best: but it is our Advantage to be determined to that which is best: it had therefore been better for Man if Nature had given him up absolutely to the Determination of his own Judgment and Understanding, and not allowed the Judgment to be suspended by the power of the Will. For by that means he would have obtained his End with greater certainty and ease. I grant, that if a Man were absolutely determin'd in his Actions to the best, there would be no room for virtue, properly so called; for virtue, as it is commonly understood, requires a free Act, and this Liberty is the very thing that is valuable in virtue; and with good reason, if a free Choice be the very thing which pleases; (For thus it would be impossible to attain the end of choosing, *i. e.* to please ourselves, without Liberty, since that very thing which pleases in Action, *viz*. Liberty, would be wanting.) But yet, if any thing which the Understanding can discover, be the very best before or independent of our Choice, it were proper for us to be necessarily determin'd to it; for the fruition of it, however obtained, would make us happy, and be so much the more valuable, as it would be certain, and not depend upon *Chance*, as all the Actions of Free-will are in a manner supposed to do: nor need we much regard the *Glory* arising from a well-made Choice; since the fruition of the greatest Good would give us Happiness without it; nay, such Glory would be empty and despicable in competition with the greatest Good. Hence it appears, that the Free-will, according to this Hypothesis, cannot be reckon'd any Advantage.

It only takes place in doubtful matters, and then 'tis of no use or importance.

VI. Secondly, If it be said, that the Understanding is dubious in many Cases, and ignorant of what is the best, and in these Liberty takes place; neither does this clear the Matter. For if the things to be done be Good or Evil in themselves, but unknown to the Intellect, there's no help in the Will; nor does its Liberty assist us in discovering or obtaining the better Side; if they be indifferent, it is no matter what we do, since the Conveniencies and Inconveniencies are equal on both Sides. If then we admit of Liberty in these Cases, it will be of no use or Importance to Life or Happiness: Nay, it must be esteemed an Imperfection, as deriving its Origin from the Imperfection of the Understanding. For if the Understanding could certainly determine what were the best to be done, there would be no room for Liberty.

We are left in doubt concerning the Way to Happiness, and can have no help from Liberty.

VII. Thirdly, These men are not well agreed what this *Chief Good* is, from the connection with which the Understanding must judge of the Goodness of other things, as may appear from their various and contradictory Opinions about it. We must necessarily thereof be wavering and sollicitous, and even rebel against Nature itself, which has neither fixt a certain End, nor granted any certain Means to attain it, but left us in anxiety and doubt about the way which leads to Happiness; neither is there any help here in our Liberty, since it is blind, and can do nothing towards bringing us back into the right way.

Since that is good which is agreeable, and this is to be judged of by the Understanding, if the Will follow this Judgment, it is not free, if it does not, it acts against reason. We had better therefore be without such Liberty.

VIII. Fourthly, 'Tis confess'd by all, that Good in general is what is universally agreeable, and what all desire. Every Good therefore answers to some Appetite, and according to these Authors, Objects are good on account of a natural and necessary suitableness which they have to our Appetites. The Understanding therefore does not make good, but finds it in the things themselves: and when it judges any thing in Nature to be agreeable, that, according to them, must necessarily be in respect of some natural Appetite. All the Good then which is in things will be the Object of some Faculty or Appetite, *i. e.* of the Understanding, Sense, &*c*. But all these are determin'd by Nature in regard to the Appetite or Faculty to which they relate, *i. e.* in regard to their *Pleasantness*, or Agreeableness; and as to the relation which they bear to each other, *i. e.* as to their *Profitableness* and *Honesty*, they are to be judg'd of by the Understanding, and directed when and in what manner they must give place to each other, or afford their mutual assistance. Free-will then appears to be of no manner of use; for if it certainly follow the decree of reason, it is not free, at least from necessity, since that very reason which it follows is not free: if it does not necessarily follow that, we had better be without it, since it perverts every thing, and confounds the Order of Reason, which is best; such a Liberty as this would therefore be prejudicial to Mankind; it would make them liable to do amiss, and produce no kind of Good to compensate for so great an Evil.

If the Will could suspend its act contrary to the Judgment of the Understanding, it would run directly into Evil; it seems therefore necessary for it to act at the time and in the manner which the Understanding directs.

IX. Fifthly, It is supposed that the Judgment of the Understanding concerning the Goodness of any thing, is a condition without which the Will is not directed to the Object, but yet that it can either exert or suspend its act about any Good whatsoever. Let us suppose then that the Understanding has determined it to be good to exert some certain Action and evil to suspend it; while this Judgment continues, if the Will can suspend its Act, it chooses Evil; if it cannot, it is not free. You'll say, it can command the Understanding to change its Judgment: be it so. But it is evident, that the Man suspends his Action before he can command the Understanding to change its Judgment, *i. e.* he suspends the Action while the Judgment determines that it is Evil to suspend; and of consequence chooses that directly which his Reason judges to be Evil; which seems to overthrow their whole Hypothesis.

There are Answers offered to these difficulties, but they are far from being clear. On this account many have gone over to the former Opinion.

X. I confess, they offer some Solutions here, but such as are so subtle, so obscure, and so much above the comprehension of the Vulgar, that most Persons have taken a distaste to them, given up the cause of Liberty as desperate, and gone over to the former Sect: but if any one will undertake either to give a more clear and full Explication of the common Opinion, or bring Solutions of those Difficulties which occur in it, he will find me so far from being his Adversary, that he may expect my assent, encouragement and assistance. This indeed were very much to be wished, but in the mean time I shall endeavour to see whether these things cannot be explained more clearly in another manner.

SUBSECT. III.

Another Notion of Liberty and Election proposed.

The Appetites and Powers attain their proper End, by Exercise, which is the greatest perfection of them, and their best Estate.

I. IN order to make my meaning better understood, we must observe, in the *first* place, that there are certain Powers, Faculties and Appetites implanted in us by Nature, which are designed for Action; and when these exert their proper Actions about Objects, they produce a grateful and agreeable Sensation in us. The exercise of them therefore pleases us; and from hence probably all our Pleasure and Delight arises; consequently our Happiness, if we have any, seems to consist in the proper exercise of those Powers and Faculties which Nature has bestowed upon us: for they appear to be implanted in us for no other end, but that by the use and exercise of them those things may be effected which are agreeable. Nor can they be at rest, or enjoy themselves any otherwise than as those things are produced by or in them, for the production or reception of which they are designed by Nature. Now every Power or Faculty is directed to the prosecution of its proper Acts. They attain their End therefore by Exercise, which must be esteemed the greatest Perfection, and most happy State of any Being. For that is a State of Happiness, if any such can be conceived, wherein every thing is done which pleases, and every thing removed which is displeasing: neither doth it seem possible to imagine a more happy one.

There is a certain agreement fixt by Nature between some Appetites, &*c*. and their Objects, whereby they act upon their Objects.

II. Secondly, It is to be observed, that among our Appetites, Faculties and Powers, some are determined to their Operations by objects peculiar to themselves. For upon the presence of their Objects they necessarily exert their Actions, if rightly disposed, and cease from Operation upon their absence, and have no tendency towards any other Objects but their own. Thus the Sight perceives nothing but Light, Colours, &*c*. and upon the Removal of these, its Action ceases. The Understanding itself distinguishes those Objects which are communicated to it by the Senses, or perceived by reflection, from one another; disposes and reposits them in the Memory; but yet has certain bounds which it cannot exceed: and so of the rest. There is therefore a certain natural Fitness, a fixt conformity between these Powers and their Objects, on which account they exert their Actions upon the presence of the Objects, and delight themselves in Exercise: but are uneasy at the presence of those things which hinder it. If then there be any natural force in any Object to promote or hinder the exercise of any Power or Faculty, that Object in regard to it is to be esteemed Good or Evil.

Liberty would be of disservice to an Agent endowed with such Appetites, &c. as these only.

III. Those Objects which thus promote or impede the Action, are sufficiently distinguished from each other by the Power or Faculty itself; those that are absent or future,

are judged of by the Understanding, and what the Mind determines to be the best in them, that we are obliged to pursue. He that does otherwise disobeys the Law of Reason. If therefore all our Powers and Faculties were thus determined to their proper Objects, it would seem an Imperfection for Man to be free, and he would have been much more happy without such a Liberty: for he receives no Benefit from it, but one of the greatest Evils, *viz*. a Power of doing amiss.

We may conceive a Power between which and any particular Object there is naturally no other agreeableness but what may arise from the Determination of the Power itself.

IV. It seems not impossible to conceive a Power of a quite different Nature from these, which may be more indifferent in respect of the Objects about which it exercises itself. To which no one thing is naturally more agreeable than another, but that will be the fittest to which it shall happen to be applyed: Between which and the Object, to which it is determined, by it self or by something else, there should naturally be no suitableness or connection than between it and any other thing; but all the *Suitableness* there is, should arise for the *Application* or *Determination* itself. For as the Earth is no Man's Right by nature, but belongs to the prime Occupant, and the Right arises from that very Occupation; so there may possibly be a Power to which no Object is by Nature peculiarly adapted, but any thing may become suitable to it, if it happen to be applyed; since its Suitableness proceeds from the Application, as we said before. Now it does not seem any more absurd for a Power to create an Agreeableness between itself and an Object, by applying itself to that Object, or that to itself, than for a Man to acquire a Right to a thing by occupying it. For, as in Civil Laws, some things are forbidden because they are inconvenient, others are inconvenient and Evil because forbidden; so it may be in Powers, Faculties and Appetites; *viz*. some may be determined by the natural Suitableness of the Objects, and in others, the Suitableness to the Objects may arise from the Determination. For this Faculty may be naturally inclined to exercise, and one Exercise be more agreeable than another, not from any natural fitness of one more than another, but from the Application of the Faculty itself; since another would often be no less agreeable, if it had happened to be determined to that. Nothing therefore seems to hinder but that there may be such a Power or Faculty, at least with respect to very many Objects.

Such a Power as this cannot be determined by *Goodness* in Objects, since the Goodness of them depends upon its determination.

V. Fourthly, if then we suppose such a Power as this, 'tis plain, that the Agent endowed with it cannot be determined in its Operations by any pre-existent Goodness in the Objects; for since the agreeableness between it and the Objects, at least in most of them, is supposed to arise from the Determination, the agreeableness cannot possibly be the Cause of that Determination on which itself depends. But the congruity of the Object with the Faculty is all the Goodness in it, therefore there is nothing Good in regard to this Power, at least in those Objects to which it is indifferent, till it has embraced it, nor Evil till it has rejected it: Since then the Determination of the Power to the Object is prior to the Goodness and the Cause of it, this Power cannot be determined by that Goodness in its Operations.

Nor by any *Uneasiness*.

VI. Fifthly, Such a Power as this, if it be granted to exist, cannot be determined by any *Uneasiness* arising from the things about which it is conversant. For it is supposed to be indifferent, not only in respect of external Objects, but also of its own Operations, and will please itself, whether it accepts the thing or rejects it; whether it exerts this Act or another. These Objects then will neither please nor displease till this indifference be removed; but it is supposed to be removed by the Application or Determination of the Power itself; therefore Anxiety does not produce but pre-suppose its Determination. Let us suppose this Power to be already determined (it matters not how) to embrace a certain Object, or to exert the proper Actions relating to it, *Desire* manifestly follows this Determination, and Desire is followed by an Endeavour to obtain and enjoy the Object pursuant to the Application of the Power. But if any thing should hinder or stop this endeavour, and prevent the Power from exerting those Operations which it undertook to discharge in relation to the Object, then indeed Uneasiness would arise from the hindrance of the Power. *Anxiety* would therefore be the *Effect* of the Determination of this Power, but by no means the *Cause* of it.*

Not by the *Understanding*.

VII. Sixthly, Supposing such an Agent as this to be endowed also with Understanding, he might use it to propose Matters fit to be done, but not to determine whether he should do them or not. For the Understanding or Reason, if it speak Truth, represents what is in the Objects, and does not feign what it finds not in them: Since therefore, before the Determination of this Power, things are supposed to be indifferent to it, and no one better or worse than another; the Understanding, if it performs its Duty right, will represent this Indifference, and not pronounce one to be more eligible than another; For the Understanding directs a thing to be done no otherwise than by determining that it is better; as therefore the Goodness of things, with respect to this Power, depends upon its Determination, and they are for the most part good if it embrace, and evil if it reject them, 'tis manifest that the Judgment of the Understanding concerning things depends upon the same, and that it cannot pronounce upon the Goodness or Badness of them, till it perceives whether the Power has embraced or rejected them. The Understanding therefore must wait for the Determination of this Power, before it can pass a Judgment, instead of the Power's waiting for the Judgment of that Understanding before it can be determined.

Yet such an Agent has need of Understanding in order to distinguish possible things from impossible.

VIII. Seventhly, But though this Power cannot be determined in its Operations by any Judgment of the Understanding, yet the Understanding is necessary, in order to propose Matters of Action, and to distinguish possible ones from those that are impossible. For though the Goodness of things with respect to the Agent, proceeds from the Determina-

* Observe what follows from Mr. *Locke*, "There is a Case wherein a Man is at Liberty in respect of *willing*, and that is the chusing a remote Good as an End to be pursued. Here a Man may *suspend* the act of his Choice from being determined for or against the thing proposed, 'till he has examined whether it be really of a Nature in itself, and Consequences to make him happy or no. For when he has once *chosen* it, and *thereby* it is become a part of his Happiness, it raises *Desire*, and this proportionably gives him *Uneasiness*, which determines his Will, and sets him at work in pursuit of his Choice on all occasions that offer." B. 2. C. 21. Sect. 56.

tion, yet the Possibility is in the things themselves, and there is need of the Understanding to distinguish between Objects, left this agent falling upon Absurdities, procure to itself Uneasiness. Not that an Object is therefore Good because 'tis possible; for if it be rejected it will be Evil; nor will it be immediately disagreeable because impossible, for attempting an Impossibility may be pleasing to us, as we may prefer the exercise of this Power, (which is the thing that pleases us, as we said before) but he that makes this Attempt, must necessarily be unhappy in the Event; for since the thing which the Power undertakes is impossible to be done, Uneasiness must necessarily follow the hindrance of its Exercise, and the final Disappointment of its End.

If the Agent be of infinite Power, he needs no other Limitation.

IX. This then must be assigned as the *first Limitation* of such a Power, *viz*. that it confine itself to Possibilities, and there needs no other, if the Agent be of infinite Power, in order to the obtaining of its End.

But an Agent of finite Power must also consult his Abilities.

X. Eighthly, But if the Agent's Power be finite, it has need also to consult its Abilities, and not determine itself to any thing which may exceed them, otherwise it will be as much disappointed in its Endeavour as if it had attempted absolute Impossibilities. And this is the *second Limitation* of this Power. It is impossible, you'll say, for an Appetite to pursue such things as the Understanding evidently declares not to be in the Power of the Agent. I answer, the Senses and natural Appetites are gratified with their Objects, and please themselves, though Reason remonstrate against them, and condemn that pleasure as pernicious. How much more easily then may this *factitious Appetite*, which arises in the Agent from Application only, be conceived to delight in its good, though the Understanding oppose it, and condemn that Delight as foolish and of short Duration. Why Nature granted such a Liberty to this Power, and how it conduces to the Good of the whole, will be shewn afterwards.

Such an Agent cannot be determined by his other Appetites.

XI. Hitherto we have either considered this Power alone in the Agent, or as joined with the Understanding. But the Agent endowed with it, may also have other Powers and Appetites which are determined to their Objects by a natural Congruity; yet neither can it be determined in its Operations by them. We must distinguish between the *Operations* of these Appetites, and the *Pleasure* which arises from the Exercise of them. These, when rightly disposed, must necessarily exert their Operations upon the presence of their Objects; but it is not at all necessary that they should delight and please themselves in these Operations. For instance, a bitter and nauseous savour is disagreeable to the Taste: but though this felt, yet urgent Hunger makes it pleasant, the craving of the Appetite overcoming the Disagreeableness of the Taste. This Pleasure indeed is not pure, but mixed and diluted proportionably to the Excess of the prevailing Appetite. For, suppose that there are three Degrees of Uneasiness from the Hunger, and two from the Bitterness; the Agent, to avoid three, must necessarily bear two; which being deducted, there remains only one Degree of solid Pleasure; whereas if he had met with suitable and sweet Food, there would have been there.

This Power is superior to all the Appetites, and subdued by none.

XII. Since therefore the Pleasure which arises from the Satisfaction of these natural Appetites may be overcome by a stronger Appetite, there's no Reason to doubt but this Power which is indifferent to Objects may overcome all the other Powers and Appetites. For all these are limited by their Objects, and therefore have certain Bounds, but this Power has not Bounds, nor is there any thing wherein it cannot please itself, if it does but happen to be determined to it. Now since the natural Appetites themselves may be contrary to each other (as we have shewn) and one of them be overcome by the Excess of another, how much more easily may this power be conceived to go against these Appetites, and since it is of a very different and superior kind, 'tis probable that it can conquer all others, and be itself subdued by none.

It seems to be given for this End, that the Agent might have something to delight in when the natural Appetites must necessarily be frustrated.

XIII. Nay we may imagine it to be given for this very End, that the Agent might have wherein to please itself, when those things which are agreeable to the natural Appetites cannot be had, as it very often happens. As the natural Powers, and Appetites receive Pleasure and Pain from Objects, they must necessarily be deprived of Pleasure and undergo Pain, according to the Laws of Motion, and the order of external things. Since then they are often frustrated, they must render the Agents possessed of them liable to Misery, as well as make them capable of Happiness; But the Agent can have this always to delight itself in; and 'tis an advantage to it to be able to quit the other Appetites, and please itself in restraining them, or acting contrary to them. For since every Faculty is satisfied in its exercise, the Strength of this cannot be more signally displayed in any thing, than in running counter sometimes to all the Appetites. For this must either be sometimes done, or the Agent must be destitute of all manner of Good, and remain entirely miserable; since by the Laws of Nature, things contrary to the Appetites must be endured.

This Power, by its accession, encreases the pleasure of the other Appetites; by opposition removes, or at least alleviates the pain.

XIV. And from hence it is very evident how desirable such a Power as this would be: for if it happen to be determined to such things as are agreeable to the Appetites, it augments, it multiplies the Enjoyment; but if it should be determined to undergo those things which are repugnant to the Appetites, and which must necessarily be born sometimes, it might diminish, nay quite remove the Uneasiness, or convert it into Pleasure.

The rest of the Appetites are not to be baulked unnecessarily.

XV. It must be confessed that some kind of struggle will be hereby excited in this Agent; but a struggle attended with some Pleasure, though it be qualified and not perfectly pure, is better than to be under absolute Misery. Nay, the consciousness of a Power to please itself against the bent and Inclination of the natural Appetites, may cause a greater Pleasure than could arise from the fruition of those things which would, if present, gratify these Appetites. Yet this Agent is obliged to have some regard to the Appetites, and not to disturb them unnecessarily, nor restrain them from a due enjoyment of their proper Objects. He that does this will bring upon himself uneasiness, and needless contest. Though therefore it be not at all proper that such a Power should be absolutely determined by the

natural Appetites, yet it is fit that they should persuade it, and that some regard be had to them in its Determinations. And this may be reckoned its *third Limitation*.

Such an Agent as this is Self-active.

XVI. Ninthly, An Agent possessed of such a Principle as this would be *Self-active*, and capable of being determined in its Operations by itself alone. Now there is sometimes an absolute necessity for it to be determined; for when any thing is proposed to be done immediately, it must necessarily either act or suspend its Action: one of them must necessarily be; but when either of them is done, the Power is determined by that very act: and no less force is requisite to suspend than to exert the act, as common Sense and Experience may inform any one. A determination then about a thing once proposed to be done, is unavoidable; and since it can neither be determined by any Good or Evil pre-existent in the Objects, nor by the natural Powers or Appetites, nor by their Objects; it must of necessity either continue undetermined, or else determine itself. But though it be naturally free from any determination, yet the Nature of the thing requires that it should be determined on every particular occasion; and since there is nothing external to do this, it remains that it determine itself. We shall call this Determination an *Election*; for as it is naturally indifferent to many things, it will please itself in electing one before another.

Is determined by himself, and things
are not chosen because they please him,
but please him because they are chosen.

XVII. Nor is it a proper Question to ask, What determines it to an Election? For if any such thing were supposed, it would not be indifferent; *i. e.* 'tis contrary to the Nature of this Agent that there should be any thing at all to determine it. In relation to a *passive Power*, which has a natural and necessary connection with the Object, the presence of which determines it to act, we may reasonably enquire what that Good is which may determine it to exert any particular action; but it is not so in an *active* Power, the very Nature of which is to *make* an Object agreeable to itself, *i. e.* good, by its own proper act. For here the Goodness of the Object does not precede the act of Election, so as to excite it, but Election makes the Goodness in the Object; that is, the thing is agreeable because chosen, and not chosen because agreeable: We cannot therefore justly enquire after any other cause of Election than the Power itself.

Yet he is not determined by Chance.

XVIII. If these things be true, you'll say, this Agent will be determined by *Chance*, and not by *Reason*; but in reality here's no room for Chance, if by Chance be understood that which happens beside the Intention of the Agent: for this very Election is the Intention of the Agent: for this very Election is the Intention of the Agent, and it is impossible that a Man should intend beside his Intention. As for *Reason*, he that prefers a less Good to a greater, must be judged to act unreasonably; but he that makes that a greater Good by choosing it, which before his choice had either no Good at all in it, or a less, he certainly chooses with reason. You may urge that *Contingency* at least is to be admitted; if by this you mean that this Agent does some things which are not at all necessary, I readily own such a Contingency, for that is the very Liberty I would establish.

Is the true Cause of his Actions.

XIX. Tenthly, 'Tis evident that such an Agent as this, if it be allowed that there is such an one, is the true *Cause* of his Actions, and that whatever he does may justly be imputed to him. A Power which is not Master of itself, but determined to act by some other, is in reality not the *efficient* Cause of its actions, but only the *instrumental* or *occasional*, (if we may use the term of some Philosophers) for it may be said that the thing is done in it, or by it, rather than that it does the thing itself. No Person therefore imputes to himself, or esteems himself the Cause of those actions to which he believes himself to be necessarily determined: If then any inconvenience arise from them, he will look upon it as a Misfortune, but not as a Crime; and whatever it be, he will refer it to the Determiner. Nor will he be angry with himself, unless he be conscious that it was in his power not to have done them: but he cannot be conscious of this (except through ignorance and error) who is determined by another. For no others ought to be looked upon as true Causes, but such as are *free*. Those that operate necessarily, are to be conceived as *passive*, and we must recur to some other which imposes that necessity on them, till we arrive at one that is free, where we must stop. Since then the Agent endowed with this power, is determined by himself and no other, and is free in his Operations, we must acquiesce in him as a real Cause, and he ought to be esteemed the Author of whatever he does, well or ill.

Is capable of Happiness.

XX. Eleventhly, 'Tis manifest that such an Agent as this is capable of *Happiness*. For that Person must be happy who can always please himself, and this Agent can evidently do so. For since things are supposed to please him, not by any necessity of Nature, but by mere Election, and there is nothing which can compel him to choose this rather than another; 'tis plain that the Agent endowed with this Power may always choose such things as it can enjoy, and refuse, *i. e.* not desire, or not choose those things which are impossible to be had. And from hence it appears of how great Importance it is, whether that agreeableness by which things please the Appetites, be established by Nature, or effected by the Agent himself. For if Good and Evil proceed from Nature and be inherent in Objects, so as to render them agreeable or disagreeable, antecedent to the Election, the Happiness of this Agent will also depend upon them; and unless the whole Series of things be so ordered, that nothing can happen contrary to his Appetites, he must fall short of Happiness. For his Appetites will be disappointed, which is the very thing we call Unhappiness. But if Objects derive their agreeableness or disagreeableness from the Choices, 'tis clear that he who has his Choice may always enjoy the thing chosen, (unless he choose Impossibilities, &*c*.) and never have his Appetite frustrated, *i. e.* be always happy. Not that *all* things are indifferent with respect to this Power, for it admits of some Limitations, as was observed, by choosing beyond which it must necessarily fail of Happiness.

An imperfect understanding is sufficient for his happiness,
if he do but distinguish between possibilities, and impossibilities,
things agreeable an disagreeable to the senses, and consult his Abilities.

XXI. Twelfthly, It is to be observed that Agents, whose Felicity depends upon the agreement of external Objects to their Appetites, stand in need of a perfect and almost infinite Knowledge to comprehend distinctly all the relations, habitudes, natures and consequences of things; if they come short of it, it is impossible but that they must often fall into pernicious Errors, and be disappointed of their Desires, that is, be often miserable: Hence anxiety and disquiet of Mind must necessarily arise, and they would be agitated

with continual doubts and uncertainty, left what they choose should not prove the best. These Agents then were either to be created without a prospect of Futurity, or to be endowed with a perfect Understanding; if neither were done, they must of necessity be very miserable; for we can scarce conceive a greater Misery than to be held in suspense about Happiness, and compelled to choose among Objects not sufficiently known, in which nevertheless a Mistake would be attended with unavoidable Misery. There's none but is sufficiently apprehensive how anxious, now solicitous, how miserable it must be to hang in such a doubt as this; but if the agreeableness of things be supposed to depend upon *Election*, a very imperfect understanding will serve to direct this Agent, nor need he to comprehend all the natures and habitudes of things: for if he do but distinguish possible things from impossible, those things which are pleasant to the Senses from them that are unpleasant, that which is agreeable to the Faculties, from what is disagreeable, and consult his own Abilities, *viz*. how far his Power reaches; (all which are easily discovered) he will know enough to make him happy. Nor is there need of long deliberation, whether any thing to be done be the very best; for if the Election be but made within these bounds, that will become best which is chosen.

Though Liberty would be a prejudice to other Agents, yet it is a sure foundation of Happiness to this, whose convenience depends not on Objects, but Election.

XXII. He that enjoys the Principle of pleasing himself in his Choice cannot reasonably complain of Nature, though he have but a very imperfect Understanding; for there will always be Objects enough ready to offer themselves within these bounds, upon which he may exercise his choice, and please himself: that is, he may always enjoy Happiness. Though Free-will then be of no use, as was said before, to an Agent capable of being determined only by the convenience of external things, nay, though it be pernicious, as only tending to pervert Reason and produce Sin; yet to an Agent whose convenience does not depend upon the things, but the choice, it is of the greatest Importance, and as we have seen, the sure and only Foundation of Felicity. And from hence it appears how valuable and how desirable such an active Principle as this would be.

These things are clear enough though they may appear to be a little too subtle.

XXIII. All this seems to be coherent enough, clear enough, and easy to be understood, tho' some may look upon it as a little too subtle. It remains that we enquire whether this be a mere Hypothesis without any Foundation in fact, or there is really such a Principle to be found in Nature.

SUBSECT. IV.

That there is an Agent who is pleas'd with Objects only because he chooses them.

God is such an Agent as this.

I. WE have seen in the former Subsection, that some things are adapted to the Appetites by the constitution of Nature itself, and on that account are good and agreeable to them; but that we may conceive a Power which can produce Goodness or Agreeableness in the things, by conforming itself to them, or adapting them to it: hence things please this Agent, not because they are good in themselves, but become good because they are chosen. We have demonstrated before, how great a perfection, and of what use such a Power would be, and that there is such a Power in Nature appears from hence, *viz*. we must necessarily believe that *God* is invested with it.

Because nothing external is either good or bad to him before Election.

II. For in the first place, nothing in the Creation is either Good or Bad to him before his Election, he has no Appetite to gratify with the Enjoyment of things without him. He is therefore absolutely *indifferent* to all external things, and can neither receive benefit nor harm from any of them. What then should determine his Will to act? Certainly nothing *without* him; therefore he determines himself, and creates to himself a kind of Appetite by choosing. For when the Choice is made, he will have as great attention and regard to the effectual procuring of that which he has chosen, as if he were excited to this Endeavour by a natural and necessary Appetite. And he will esteem such things as tend to accomplish these Elections, Good; such as obstruct them, Evil.

Because his own Will is of the Cause of Goodness in the Creatures.

III. Secondly, the Divine Will is the Cause of Good in the Creatures, and upon it they depend, as almost every one acknowledges. For created Beings have all that they have from the Will of God; nor can they be any thing else than what he willed. 'Tis plain then that all these agree and are conformable to his Will, either efficient or permissive, and that their original Goodness is founded in this Conformity. And since all things proceed from one and the same Will, which cannot be contrary to itself, as it is restrain'd within its proper bounds by infinite Wisdom, 'tis also certain that all things are consistent with each other, that every thing contributes as much as possible to the preservation of itself and the whole System; which we must reckon of the Creatures is owing to the Divine Will, and dependent on it; for we cannot apprehend how they could be either Good or Evil in themselves, since they were nothing at all antecedent to the act of the Divine Will: and they were as far from being good with regard to God himself, till upon willing their Existence he by that act of Election both contributed them Good in relation to him; and by an unity of Will made them agreeable to one another. 'Tis evident that the Divine Will was accompanied in this, as in all other Cases, by this Goodness and Wisdom; but it proceeds immediately from his Will that things please God, *i. e.* are *Good*. For many things are not agreeable to this Goodness and Wisdom purely because he did not will them, and while he does not will any thing it cannot be good.

From whence it appears undeniably that his Will could not be determin'd to Election by any Goodness in the Creatures. For before that Election, which is declared to be the Cause of Goodness in created Beings, nothing could be either Good or Bad; but when the Election is made, that only is Evil which obstructs the execution of it, and that Good which promotes it. The Goodness of things is therefore to be determin'd by their agreeableness to the Divine Will, and not that by the agreeableness or goodness of things.

IV. Thirdly, We must not therefore attend to such as declare that God chooses things because they are Good, as if Goodness and the greater Good which he perceives in Objects, could determine his Will. If the Matter had stood thus, it does not seem possible for the World to have been made at all. For they who acknowledge God to be the Author of it, confess also, that he is absolutely and completely happy in himself, and does not stand in the least need of other things. Now it is inconceivable how external things can be

of use to God, who comprehends in himself all things which tend to perfect Happiness. He must of necessity therefore be indifferent to all external Objects, nor can any reason be assign'd with regard to the things themselves, why he should prefer one to another. 'Tis plain that things are made by God with Goodness, that is, with a certain congruity to his own Nature; but they are so far from being made on account of any agreeableness antecedent to the Divine Will, that, on the contrary, they are necessarily agreeable and pleasant because they are made by his free Choice. For since they are nothing in themselves, they must of necessity have both their Existence and their agreeableness from that Will, from which they solely proceed; and it is impossible but that they should be conformable to the Will which effected them: For God, by willing, makes those things pleasing to him which were before indifferent.

If he had now a power of pleasing himself in Election, he could never have made any thing.

V. Unless therefore we attribute to him such a Power as has been described (namely, an ability to please himself, by determining himself to action without any other regard had to the Quality of the Object, than that it is possible) it seems impossible that ever he should begin to effect any thing without himself. For, as far as we can apprehend, there can be no reason assign'd why he should create any thing at all, why a World, why the present, why at that particular time when it was created, why not before or after, why in this and no other Form: he receiv'd no advantage or disadvantage from these, no benefit or harm; in short, nothing that could move him to choose one before another. Except therefore we attribute to God an active power of determining himself in indifferent Matters, upon every particular Occasion, and of pleasing himself in that Determination according to his Choice; he would do nothing at all, he would be for ever indolent in regard to all external things, and the World could not possibly have been made, since no reason could be imagin'd, why a God absolutely perfect in himself, and absolutely happy, should create any thing without himself.

If he were moved by the Goodness of things to create the World, he would be a necessary Agent.

VI. Fourthly, If we suppose that there was a reason, and that God was moved by it to produce external things, 'tis manifest, that according to this all things will proceed from this necessarily. For he that is determin'd *ab extra* to do any thing, acts by necessity; he is passive, and must necessarily both do and suffer, not what he himself, but what the determining Cause has effected in him: But this Goodness (which is supposed to be in things antecedent to the Divine Election, and to determine it) is somewhat External, with regard to the Will of God; if therefore that be the Cause which determines the Election, it follows that the act of Election and every thing that depends upon it is necessary.

But if things are good because he has chosen to make them, his whole Work will be free.

VII. But if things be good and agreeable to God for this only reason because he has chosen to make them so, he himself will be at liberty, his whole Work will be free. The World will be made not of necessity, but choice; nor will it be impossible to be effected, tho' it be in itself unprofitable to the Deity, for he will have a complacency in his own Choice. And from hence it sufficiently appears of how great Importance it is, that all the Goodness of the Creatures should depend on the Divine Election, and not that upon the Goodness of them; for so we may conceive Fate to be taken away and Liberty establish'd.

External things are in themselves absolutely indifferent to God, but he has a complacency in his Choice.

VIII. Fifthly, If he expected no advantage, you'll say, from the Objects of his Choice, why should he choose them? Is it not more probable that he should do nothing at all, than busy himelf in things that are like to be of no benefit? I answer, That it is no more trouble to him to will things than not to will them; and hence it comes to pass that when he wills them, they exist; when he retracts that Will, they drop into nothing. Which reason, as it supposes an indifference of things in respect of God, so it asserts his Liberty to produce or not produce them, and proves that that will be agreeable to him which he shall choose. But we have a better yet at hand, *viz*. that God chose to create external things that there might be something for him to delight in without himself. For every one receives Satisfaction from the Exercise of his Powers and Faculties. Now God is invested with infinite Power, which he can exercise innumerable Ways, not all at once indeed, (for all are not consistent with each other) but such as are consistent are for the most part indifferent, nor is there any reason why he should prefer one before another, it must therefore be his own Choice which makes one more agreeable than another; nor is it otherwise conceivable how a thing that is in itself indifferent to the Elector, should prove more pleasing than any thing else.

And determines himself to Action.

IX. Neither ought we to enquire for any reason of the Election, *i. e.* why he chooses this rather than that; for upon supposition that there is a reason the indifference would be destroy'd, and the Election would not be free. If we suppose that there is such a thing as better and worse in the Objects themselves, who would affirm that the Goodness and Wisdom of God will not necessarily determine him to choose the better? For who can honestly postpone the better and prefer the worse? As then in indifferent Matters there can be no reason why one is chosen before another so there is no need of any: for since the Divine Will is self-active, and must necessarily be determined to one of the indifferent things, it is its own reason of Action, and determines itself freely. Nay so great is the Power of God, that whatever he shall choose out of infinite Possibilities, that will be the best; 'tis all one therefore which he prefers.

The difficulty of conceiving how a power can determine itself to action ought not to hinder our assent to the truth of the proposition.

X. Sixthly, But you urge that you are still unsatisfy'd how a Power can *determine itself*, i. e. you are ignorant of the *Modus*; but a thing must not be denyed because we do not know the manner how it is done: we are entirely ignorant how the Rays of the Sun produce the Idea of Light in the Mind by moving the optic Nerves; nor is it better understood how the Members of the Body can be moved by a Thought of the Mind, and at the Direction of the Will. Yet no body denies these things, because he knows not the manner in which they are performed. If therefore it be manifest that the divine Will does determine itself, we shall not trouble ourselves much in enquiring how it can be done.

'Tis as difficult to conceive how a thing can be moved by another, as by itself: we are prejudiced by being accustomed to material, *i. e.* passive Agents.

XI. But to confess the truth, 'tis no less difficult to conceive a thing to be moved or determined by another, than by itself; but as we are accustomed to material Agents, all which are passive in their Operations, we are certain of the Fact, and not at all solicitous about the manner of it: whereas if we consider the thing thoroughly, we shall find ourselves as far from apprehending how Motion is communicated from one Body to another, as how the Will can move itself: but there seems to be nothing wonderful in the one, because it is observed to happen at all times, and in every Action; whereas the other is looked upon as incredible, since it is seldom performed, *viz*. by the Will alone. And tho' both Reason and Experience prove that it is done, yet we suspect ourselves to be imposed upon, because we know not the manner of it. The ground of the mistakes is this, that since the Will is the only active Power which we are acquainted with, the rest being all passive, we are not easily induced to believe it to be really such, but form our Judgment of it from a Comparison with other Agents, which since they don't move but as they are moved, we require a Mover also in the Will of God: which is very absurd; since it is evident that if there were no *active* Power in Nature, there could not be a *passive* one; and if nothing could move without a Mover, there would have been no Motion or Action at all. For we cannot conceive how it should begin. Now it is much harder to conceive how Motion can be without a Beginning, than how an Agent can move itself. Since then here are Difficulties on both Sides, neither ought to be denied because the manner of it is above human Understanding.

What is said about indifference, with respect to the Will of God, takes place in his primary Elections.

XII. It is to be observed, that what we have said concerning this Indifference of things in regard to the Divine Will, takes place chiefly in those Elections which we apprehend to be the *Primary*, but not always in the subsequent ones. For supposing God to will any thing, while that Election continues, he cannot reject either the same or any thing necessarily connected with it, for that would be to contradict himself. In order to apprehend my Meaning the better, we must remember that the Divine Power can effect innumerable things equal in Nature and Perfections. For instance, we may conceive numberless Men equal to one another in all respects; and also numberless Species of rational Beings equally perfect: nothing but the Will of God could determine which of these he should create first. But when it was determin'd to create Man such as he now is, *i. e.* with the Faculties, Appetites, and integral Parts which he consists of at present, it is impossible that God should will or choose any thing repugnant to human Nature, while that Election continues.

God may have all things at once in his view which are connected with the thing chosen, and either will or refuse them by one simple Act.

XIII. For when we conceive any thing proposed to the Knowledge of God as fit to be done, he must also necessarily have under his Eye, as it were at the same Glance, all those things that are necessarily connected with it, or consequent there upon to all Eternity; and must will or reject them all by one simple Act. If therefore he determin'd to create Man, he must also be supposed to will that he should consist of a Soul and Body, that he should be furnish'd with Reason and Senses, and that his Body should be subject to the general Laws of Matter: for all these things are evidently included in the Choice to create Man.

As he is of infinite Goodness, he also wills the good of all things which he has determin'd to create, as far as is possible.

XIV. Nay, this primary Act of Volition must be supposed to contain not only those things which have a necessary connection with what is chosen, but such things also as tend to promote its benefit and happiness, as far as they can be made consistent with the benefit of the whole. For since God is infinitely Good, 'tis certain that he wills that his Creatures should exist commodiously as much as that they should exist at all. He therefore will'd such things as are agreeable to the Natures, and tend to preserve the Constitutions of his Creatures in the same Election whereby he determin'd to create them.

When the World therefore is once made, it is impossible that those things should please him which tend to the confusion, &*c*. of his Work.

XV. We have said before, that there is a double Goodness in things, the first and principal is that which renders them well-pleasing to God, as they are conformable to his Will: the other is that whereby they agree with one another, whereby they afford each other mutual Assistance, whereby they promote the Convenience, Preservation and Perfection of the whole: but both these proceed from the Choice and Will of God. For when the Deity had once determin'd to please himself in the Creation and Preservation of the World, he must be supposed at the same time to have willed all such things as contribute to the Benefit and Perfection of his Work, otherwise he would have contradicted himself, and thereby been the cause of frustrating his own Election. For he is now supposed to have chosen that there should be a World, that is should continue as long as he himself had determin'd, that every Being should attain the End assign'd to it, and all things act according to the Nature he had given them, and conspire together to preserve and perfect the whole. It is impossible therefore that he should will the reverse of all this, or that such things should please him as tend to the disordering, maiming or destruction of his Work. For 'tis impossible to conceive that he should choose the Existence of things, and yet refuse the Means necessary thereto.

When Man is made of such a nature as requires him to be just, sober, &*c*. God is not at Liberty not to will these things.

XVI. When therefore Man was made what he is, by that very Act of constituting him of such a Nature and Condition, 'tis plain, that God also willed that he should be pious, sober, just and chaste. These and the like Laws of Nature then are immutable, *viz*. conformable to the Will of God, and contain'd in the very first Act of Election wherein he determin'd to create Man. Nor is God at Liberty not to will these during his purpose to continue Man such as he is: For by this means the same thing would please him, as being agreeable to his first Choice of Creating Man, which is supposed to stand yet, and displease him, as being repugnant to another, which rejects the very same things that are contained in the first; that is, he would at the same time will and not will the same thing, which cannot be attributed to God.

This is no bar to the Divine Liberty.

XVII. Yet he is nevertheless free, because he cannot will that a Man be perjur'd, Murthereer, &*c*. for he is no otherwise determin'd than by his own Choice; nor does a thing please or displease him on any other account than because it is agreeable or contrary to his Will. For While that Election of the Deity which constitutes me a Man, (*i. e.* an Animal that is obliged to be pious, just and sober) remains, 'tis impossible that he should will me to be perjur'd, or a Murtherer; nor can the latter Choice take place in God so long as the former stands, since it is repugnant to the former. When therefore we acknowledge that things are good, and assert that some Actions are grateful to God, and others odious; this is not because we believe the Divine Elections to be determined by them, but because we suppose them to be comprehended in the very first Act of his Will of creating things, and to be pleasing or displeasing to him so far as they are agreeable or opposite to that Election. Nor is the Liberty of God destroy'd because he must necessarily will these things while he does will them: For every thing, while it is, necessarily is; but this Necessity is consequent upon, and not antecedent to the Divine Will. The Divine Election therefore is not determined by the Goodness of things, but the Goodness and Fitness of them arises from that Election, and that is best for them which is most agreeable to that Choice of the Deity whereby he will'd them to be what they are. From hence, I think, it appears sufficiently that God is such an Agent as delights in things merely because they are chosen.

A Being endow'd with this Power is more perfect than one that wants it: yet this does not imply infinite Perfection, therefore it is communicable.

XVIII. Yet it is to be remarked that this self-determining Power is not of such a Nature as to imply infinite Perfection; for it may be consistent with an imperfect understanding, and other Appetites, as we have shewn before: 'Tis not therefore peculiar to God, or incommunicable, there is no reason therefore for us to doubt whether a Creature may partake of it: If God were pleased to communicate it, there seems to be no contradiction in the thing for a Creature to be capable of it. Now that Being which has this gift bestowed upon it, will manifestly be more noble than the rest, and a more perfect resemblance of the Deity: since therefore God has created the less perfect Beings, we may, without any absurdity, believe that he has not omitted the more perfect. Let us see then whether there be any Tokens of this Power among the Divine Works.

SUBSECT. V.

That Man partakes of the Principles of pleasing himself by Election.

Some reasons are offer'd to shew this.

I. IT appears, I think, from what has been said that there is such a Principle in Nature, and that it is also communicable. We are now to enquire whether Nature has conferred it upon us: If we consult our own Minds, we may possibly entertain a doubt whether we are always passive in our voluntary Acts; namely, whether the Goodness of Objects determines our Elections according to the Degrees of it, which are, or are believed to be in them: or to speak more plainly, whether we always choose things because they please us or seem convenient; or whether they sometimes appear indifferent in themselves, or inconvenient before the Choice, and acquire their Goodness from it, and are for this reason only agreeable because they are chosen. We have seen that there is in Nature such a Power as this, which can produce a Convenience or Goodness in things by willing them; but whether we partake of it or no is the doubt. Now that we do partake of it may I think be evinced from the following Reasons. First, If we be conscious of an inherent Liberty. Secondly, If we experience in ourselves those Signs and Properties which have been declared to attend this Principle. Thirdly, If the Causes which are supposed to determine the Will be evidently insufficient, or arise from Election instead of producing it.

First, Experience.

II. As to the first; We experience in ourselves a Principle of this kind, (*i. e.* a free one,) to such a degree of certainty, that if our Minds be consulted we can hardly doubt of it; and from hence it is that all Men of all Nations, while they followed the Guidance of Nature, and attended to the Perceptions of their own Minds, have constantly asserted their Liberty, at least in some particular Actions: Nor has any one, unless he were forced to it, and as it were circumvented by Philosophical Subtilties, ever denied either that he as free, or that he could please himself in choosing one or other out of many Objects presented to him, though that which was preferred were no ways preferable to others in respect of any intrinsic worth.

The vulgar often judge better of matters of Fact than Philosophers.

III. In this therefore, as in many other Cases, the Vulgar seem to be much wiser, and to reason more justly than Philosophers. For the Vulgar generally follow the natural Sense of the Mind; and tho' they by dull enough in forming long Deductions, yet in such things as are the immediate Objects of Sense and Experience, they are often more acute than Philosophers themselves: who either puffed up with the Vanity of appearing wise above the Vulgar, or imposed upon by their own Subtilty, often frame Monsters of their own, and deny things that are the most manifest: while they are striving to pursue Truth through Coverts impervious and inaccessible to human Wit, they leave her behind their Back, and are blind in broad Day. Hence some have denyed Motion, and others Rest, others Space, others all Sense in Brutes, others the being of a *God*, and others all manner of Truth: and on the same account, some have deny'd Liberty, *viz*. because they were not able to unravel the Difficulties in which they themselves had involv'd it by their Subtilties. The ignorant and unlearned do much better in slighting all such Arguments, and judging of things ingenuously according to the dictate of their Senses and Experience; and if their Judgments be taken, we have clearly gained the Cause: for all these declare that they are conscious of this free Principle within them, which yet cannot, as we have shewn, be well explained otherwise than we have done: The Sense of our unprejudiced Mind agrees with these, nor is the common Testimony of Mankind to be esteemed of little importance in a matter of Fact.

'Tis proved that we partake of this Power, because we discover the Marks and Properties of it in ourselves.

IV. Secondly, If we experience in ourselves the Signs and Properties which belong to this Power, it cannot be questioned but we have the Power itself: Now these are a Self-consciousness that we are the true Cause of our Actions; an Ability to act and please ourselves in contradicting our natural Appetites, our Senses and Reason. If it be evident from

Experience that we can do these things, it will be but too certain that we have such a Power as is able to please itself barely by Election.

In the first place, we impute our Actions to ourselves whereby we own ourselves to be the true Causes of them. Hence it is that we distinguish Misfortunes from Crimes.

V. In the first place then, we have declared that a Being endowed with this Principle is the only true efficient Cause of its Actions, and that whatever it does can be imputed to it only. Now all Men impute the Actions of their own Will to themselves, and esteem them truly and properly theirs, whether they be good or bad; which is a certain Sign that they do not perceive themselves to be determined from elsewhere to the Choice or Exertion of them, otherwise they would not look upon themselves as the Cause, but the Determiner. It cannot be otherwise than from a consciousness and firm persuasion of this Truth, that wrong Elections give us more trouble than such things as proceed from Ignorance and inevitable Error. 'Tis on this account only that a light Evil occasioned by our own Choice grieves and afflicts us more than a very great one from the Action of another. If we expose ourselves to Poverty, Disgrace, or an untimely End, by an Act of Choice, our Conscience remonstrates against it, Remembrance stings us, and we cannot forgive ourselves, though we are secure both from human Punishment and the Wrath of God. But when the same Evils befal us by external Force or the Necessity of Nature, we bewail our Condition indeed, and complain of Fortune, but have none of that wounding Anxiousness, and vindictive Reproach of Conscience, which scourges those that become miserable by their own fault. As therefore he that enjoys this Principle must necessarily blame himself if he bring any Inconvenience upon himself by his own Choice; so he that does blame himself, demonstrates that he has this Principle. For as it is impossible but that he should accuse himself, who believes that he is the true cause of his own Misery; so on the other hand, 'tis certain that he who does accuse himself, thinks that he himself is the true cause of his Misery: otherwise he would grieve, complain, and be angry with the Person that compelled him to commit such things as he finds make him uneasy, but would never condemn himself as the Cause and Author of them, unless he were conscious that he could have hindered them. If the grief arising from a Crime be distinct from that which is occasioned by a Misfortune, 'tis plain that this can be on no other account, than because the Crime proceeds from a free Agent, *i. e.* one who determines himself to Action, but the Misfortune from a necessary one.

This is a most certain Sign that we are conscious of our liberty.

VI. 'Tis plain then from our *Conscience* of Good and Evil Actions, that we have this active Principle in some respect within us. For we not only rejoice in such things as are done well, and grieve at the contrary: but also impute them to ourselves, and either blame or applaud ourselves as the Authors and true Causes of them: which is the first and surest Sign that our Minds are sensible of their Liberty, and that they could have pleased themselves in doing otherwise than they have done.

The second token of this Power, that it can go against the Appetites, &*c.*

VII. The second Sign or Property of this Power is, that it is able to oppose the natural Appetites, Senses and Reason, and can please itself in the Opposition. If we experience this Ability in ourselves, we may be certain that we partake of such a Power.

'Tis shewn that we can do this in regard to our Appetites.

VIII. With respect to the natural Appetites, we have said before, that this Principle, when it happens to be joined with natural Appetites in the same Person, often runs counter to them, and pleases itself in restraining them; if we find that we can do this, 'tis a Sign that we have it. But who has not experienced this in himself? who has not sometimes voluntarily suffered such things as are hard, incommodious, and painful to the natural Appetites, and taken delight in such Sufferance, as a Good superior to the Gratification of the Appetites? Nay the Pain itself arising from the Violence offered to these natural Appetites, if we do but choose to bear it, becomes in a manner agreeable, which would otherwise be very irksome. From whence it is most apparent that this Pleasure depends upon the Choice; for while that continues it continues too; when that is changed, 'tis gone. Now such Elections as these are made every Day, and none can be so much a Stranger to himself, as not to be conscious of them.

That we can do it also in our Senses, and in a manner change the nature of things by an obstinate Election.

IX. It is to be observed farther, that we do not only embrace with pleasure such things as the Appetites refuse, and reject such things as they desire, but alter, as it were, Nature itself by an obstinate Election, and make these Appetites pursue what they naturally avoid, and fly what by Nature they desire. And this takes place not only in Appetites, but also in the Objects of the Senses. Some things are naturally unpleasant to them, some bitter, nauseous, deformed; yet these are made tolerable by the force of Election, and by a change of the natural Propensity, at length become Delights. On the contrary, what was sweet, beautiful, &*c.* being rejected by the Will, becomes at length disagreeable. We could not possibly do this, if we had not a Power of pleasing ourselves by other Means than the agreement of Objects to the Appetites and Senses. For whence comes it that such things as are sweet, comely, excellent, commodious; nay, all that are grateful to the Appetites and Senses should become irksome and offensive? on the contrary, whence is it that Griefs, Pains, Torments, any Death itself should be agreeable when voluntarily undergone, unless from this Principle which pleases itself in its Election? If it be granted that we have such a Principle, these things may easily be accounted for; since natural Good may, by the Power of it, be changed into Evil, and Evil into Good: for it has a Good in itself superior to these, by means of which it can overcome and alter the Nature of them: but that this cannot admit of any other Explanation will be shewn below.

That we can conquer not only our Appetites and Senses, but also our Reason by the force of Election.

X. These things are generally supposed to be done by the Power and Prescription of *Reason*; and 'tis thought, that the Will under its guidance embraces things disagreeable to the natural Appetites and Senses: I confess this sometimes is, and always ought to be done according to reason; for we have hinted above, that some regard should be had to these in Elections; but very often the Case is far otherwise. We have shewn before, that a Power which is capable of pleasing itself in Election, cannot be determined by reason; for the Understanding depends upon it, rather that *it* upon the Understanding. 'Tis therefore the *third* Mark and Property of this Power, that it can run counter, not only to *Appetites* and *Senses*, but also to *Reason*. If we can do this, we must own to our Sorrow, that we partake of it. But that we can, by the force of Election, conquer not only the Appetites and Senses, but the Understanding too, daily Experience teaches; and we have reason to lament

that it can be prov'd by so many instances that we please ourselves in Elections contrary to the natural propensity of our Senses and Appetites, and at the same time against the dictate of Reason.

'Tis appears from Instances.

XI. We have seen an Atheist supported by the Obstinacy of a perverse Mind, enduring Torments, Confinement, and Death itself, rather than abjure his beloved Impiety: We have seen a great many Persons voluntarily throwing away their Fortunes, Life and Soul, left they should be disappointed in a foolish Choice. We have beheld not a few disregarding the Intreaty of their Friends, the Advice of their Relations, the Dictates of their own Mind; Dangers, Distresses, Death, the wrath of God, and the pains of Hell; in short, despising all that is Good, or could appear to be so, when set in competition with such things as, exclusive of the Goodness which they receive from Election, are mere Trifles and worth nothing at all; such as have no manner of Good or pretence of Good in them. There have been Persons who knowingly, without any kind of hope, any kind of belief, have destroyed themselves and their Relations, and yet were in their right Mind may be judged of by sober Words and a serious tenor of Action. Did these Men follow Reason, or any other Good beside the fruition of their Choice? We have shewn already that this Power may produce these and greater Absurdities; for since it is supposed to be of such a Nature as can please itself in its Act, where ever it can exert that Act, it can also please itself, even in opposition to the natural Appetites, the Senses and Reason. If then such a Principle be granted to be in us, it will not seem strange that we should be able to do things that are repugnant to these; if this be not allow'd, it cannot be made appear how so many Absurdities, so many things disagreeable to Reason, to Sense; so many things contrary to the dictate of the Mind, should every Day be committed by Mankind.

That the Understanding admits not only evil things for good,
but Falsities for Truths, *viz*. being under subjection to the Will.

XII. Nay, which may seem more strange, the Will appears to have so great a Power over the Understanding that the latter is so far subdued by its Choice, as to take Evil things for Good, and forced to admit Falsities for Truths. Neither will this appear impossible to one who recollects that the Senses are as much natural Faculties, and have by Nature as quick a Relish of their proper Objects, and can as well distinguish those that are agreeable from them that are disagreeable, as the Understanding. If therefore we sometimes please ourselves in choosing what is repugnant to the Senses, 'tis also possible for us to take pleasure in embracing what is dissonant to Reason. The Senses are forced to admit and tolerate such things as are disgustful to them, which things they take for agreeable by use, having as complete Enjoyment of them as of those that are adapted to them by Nature. The same may happen sometimes to the Understanding, *viz*. to be compelled by the Will to admit Falsities for Truths, to believe them thro' custom, and at last make use of them seriously as Truths. Hence comes the common Saying, *that we easily believe what we eagerly desire*; and some take a pleasure in subduing not only Sense, but Reason too. I confess, he that does this, acts foolishly and is much to blame; but from this very thing, that we act foolishly, that we are to blame, 'tis evident that we not only can, but actually do please ourselves in Elections which are made contrary to Reason; and that the Judgment of our Understanding depends upon the Will, rather than that the Will is determined by it. From hence it is evident that all the Signs and Properties of a Power of pleasing itself by Election agree to us, and therefore we certainly partake of it.

'Tis proved that we have this Power from a consideration
of those reasons which are supposed to determine the Will.

XIII. The same will appear, thirdly, from considering the Reasons which move us to the choice of these Absurdities, according to the Opinion of those Men who think that the Will if *passive* in Elections. For if, while they are labouring to assign Reasons for these and the like Determinations, they produce nothing for Reasons but the very Elections themselves, of their Effects, it will be apparent that they are in a Mistake, and offer Effects for Causes; which will appear more fully from an Enumeration of those Reasons which are supposed to move the Will in such Cases.

Those are enumerated.

XIV. The Principal of these Reasons are *Errors of the Understanding*, *Obstinacy of the Mind*, *the force of Passions*, and *Madness*; on these are changed all the unreasonable, absurd, and impious Actions of Men; these are esteemed the Causes of all such Elections as cannot be allowed to proceed from the intrinsic Goodness of the Objects which are chose: but this is all groundless.

First, Errors of the Understanding: these are shewn
to depend upon deprav'd Election rather than to cause it.

XV. For in the first place, as to *Errors of the Understanding*, 'tis certain that we sometimes choose hurtful Objects by mistake, which we often lament, but never impute to ourselves, except we be conscious that the Error was voluntary, *i. e.* in some respect owed its Origin to Election. Election then is prior to all culpable Error, for that depends upon it. 'Tis not therefore always by mistake that we choose Absurdities, but by choosing Absurdities we mistake the Truth. But to confess the Truth, we are hurried on in an absurd Election, tho' we see and know all that we are about to do: if then there be any Error, 'tis only this that we judge it better to enjoy a free Election, than to be exempt from natural Evils. Hence it is evident that there arises so much Pleasure from Election as is able to impose upon the Understanding, and induce it to prefer that to all kinds of natural Good; nay to Life itself. But whether this be done erroneously or wisely, 'tis the strongest Argument that we have such an Elective Self-pleasing Principle as this within us.

Secondly, Obstinacy, which is shewn to be
nothing else but persevering in a deprav'd Election.

XVI. Secondly, as for Obstinacy, by which they suppose that we are moved to choose absurd things; 'tis plain that this is nothing else but the perseverance of a bad Election: neither can Obstinacy and Perverseness be explained otherwise than by Elections. If it be granted that these things please us because they are chosen, we see clearly enough what Obstinacy is, *viz*. an unnecessary adherence to an Election, and a Self-complacency in it, contrary to the dictate of Reason, and with the loss of natural Good. But if the Will be determined from without, there will be no such thing as Obstinacy. By an obstinate Person we only mean one that has continued a long time in a pernicious Error, without any Motive to change his Judgment. Now he that does this is miserable indeed, but cannot be called in the least degree obstinate, according to the common Notion of Mankind.

Thirdly, The violence of Passions, *viz*. Desire of Fame and Glory, &*c*. all which are prov'd to derive their inordinate force from Election.

XVII. Thirdly, since neither Errors nor Obstinacy are sufficient to explain the Nature of these Elections, they fly to the *Power of the Passions; viz*. the Desire of Fame or Glory; Anger, Hatred, &*c*. These are the Causes, say they, why we choose absurdly, and by them the Choice is determined. But Fame or Glory have no manner of Good in them, especially to those who believe that they shall not exist after Death: why then are these Men content to purchase Glory with Life? Certainly from no other Cause beside Election; 'tis by Election that we have form'd these Idols to ourselves, and from thence they derive whatever Good is in them. To be talked of after Death, to mount upon the Wings of Fame, to extend our Name to distant Regions; these things please us on no other account but because we will them. Obscurity, Oblivion, Retirement will be as pleasing to the Man that chooses them, and have been so. Those Persons then who imagine that these determine Elections, take Effects for Causes. For these, which are nothing in themselves, shew us that they acquire so much Goodness from Election as makes them over-ballance all kind of natural Good.

The same is shewn of Hatred, Love, &*c*.

XVIII. The same must be said of Anger, Hatred, Love and Despair, by which many are believed to be driven upon Absurdities. But in reality all that is absurd and pernicious in these Passions proceeds from Election. Nature has given us Passions which are generally innocent, while solicited only by their proper Objects, and natural Opportunity, as we see in Brutes; but they are compelled to change the natural Objects by the Power of Election: thus Anger and Hatred are excited by the Will, and applyed not so such things as are naturally hurtful, nor Love and Desire to such as naturally desirable, but to others of a quite different kind, with which they have no natural Congruity, such as Fame and Glory after Death. Of this kind also are most of the Instruments of Luxury, which are commonly said to please, purely by the strength of *Fancy*, that is in reality, by Election. Hence it is that Men pursue with so great eagerness and emotion such things as are in themselves trifling, pernicious, and absurd. Nay they barter away Life itself for Trifles, and when they cannot enjoy them, cast off that in dispair. 'Tis the Election itself which substitutes these things as fit to be prosecuted by these Passions instead of their natural Objects, and while they are hurried on, not according to the exigence of Nature, but the command of the Will, they confound every thing, transgress the bounds of reason and utility, and disregarding these rage without limits or restraint.

Of Envy and Revenge.

XIX. As for Envy and Revenge, they are not owing to Nature but the Will, and setting aside Election are mere nothing. For whatever is pretended to the contrary, there can be no other account given why any one should undergo Labours, Dangers, Griefs and Difficulties; why he should lose his Reputation, Family, Country, nay his Life, for the Satisfaction of his Envy or Revenge, but that he resolved within himself, but that he *chose* to satisfy them. 'Tis evident that the most unexperienced Person in sufficiently convinced of this. But these, when once embraced by Election, become more agreeable than those things which Nature has made necessary. Those absurd Elections then are not made by the force of these Passions, but the absurd and irregular force of these flows from Elections.

Fourthly, *Madness*; 'tis prov'd on the contrary that these Men are in their Senses who choose absurdly.

XX. They who perceive that these Causes are insufficient, have recourse to *Madness* and *Phrenzy*, in order to account for absurd Elections: but this is playing upon Words, and taking Madness in a different Sense from that wherein it is commonly understood. He is looked upon as mad that is so far disordered in his Mind as not to be able to deduce one Idea from another, nor make Observations upon what he sees: but these Men who do many absurd things enjoy the abovementioned Powers, and have their Understanding and Senses strong enough by Nature: what is it therefore which drives them into Absurdities? The power and prevalence of the superior Faculty, *viz*. the *Will*, which has a Good peculiar to itself, which it produces by Election. This it pursues regardless of all that Reason, the Body, Circumstances, Appetites and natural Faculties require. For while it can provide for and please itself, it is not at all solicitous about any thing which may prejudice these, but has a certain Complacency in its own Exercise, and endeavours to augment its Happiness by the pursuit of such things as are repugnant to them. The more Difficulties and Absurdities it encounters, the more it applauds itself in a consciousness of its own Abilities; which seems to be the very thing that we call *Vanity* and Pride. Hereupon it compels the Senses, Reason, and natural Appetites, to be subservient to its Elections: not can he be call'd a Madman who acts against Reason, thro' the force of a superior Faculty, any more than he that falls from a Precipice by the violence of a greater impulse. For it is not every one who acts against reason, that must immediately be looked upon as Mad, but only he that acts absurdly from some injury done to the understanding Faculty itself, or an Impediment to the Use of Reason: he that could have followed the dictate of Reason: he that could have followed the dictate of Reason and yet knowingly violated it, must not be reckoned mad, but wicked, unless we will impose upon ourselves by changing the customary Names of things.

All these things cannot be explained otherwise than by admitting a Principle of this kind.

XXI. If it be granted that we have this superior Faculty, 'tis plain enough that all these things may come to pass. For he that is endowed with it, will be able to please himself in the Prosecution of his Election, even to the detriment of both Body and Mind; to the prejudice of Senses, Appetites and Reason; which we often see done to our Amazement; but unless we have this Faculty imparted to us, it does not seem possible for us to create Good to ourselves by Election, and to prefer what is thus created to every natural Good.

As much good arises from this Principle, so it is attended with this Evil, *viz*. a Power of sinning.

XXII. These things, I confess, ought not to be done; but if nothing could be done which ought not, there would be no such thing as a Fault. As therefore much Good arises from this Principle, so there is this Evil also, that by it Crimes and Follies are committed: And it has this Inconvenience, that it can do what it ought not.

This mistake, that the Will follows the Judgment of the Understanding, arose from hence, *viz*. that it is imprudent in us to act without consulting the Understanding.

XXIII. From these and other Arguments which might be brought, I think it is evident that God has given us a Principle of this kind, and that our Will is only determined by

itself. They are mistaken therefore who affirm that either the Appetites, Passions, or Understanding, determine Elections. What probably gave occasion to the Mistake was, that other things please or displease us, beside what we choose, *viz*. such as are agreeable to the Appetites or Senses. Now it being observed that we have regard to these in Elections, and do not choose any thing repugnant to them, but upon necessity, and that all Men are of Opinion, that the Judgment of the Understanding ought to be made use of in choosing, and being accustomed to this kind of Choice, we become at last persuaded that it is absolutely necessary, and that our Wills are always determined by some Judgment of the Understanding: at least, that it is a Condition requisite in the Object, that the Mind judge the thing chosen to be good and agreeable to the Appetites. Whereas the contrary to all this is generally true, *viz*. that the Mind judge things to be good because we have willed them, because we have formed an Appetite in ourselves by some antecedent Election, and those things which we embrace by this factitious *Appetite*, as we may call it, give us equal Pleasure with that which we desire by the Necessity of Nature.

We can act in order to shew our Liberty, which is
proved to be the same as acting without any reason at all.

XXIV. Nay, we choose Objects which are contrary to all the Appetites, contrary to Reason, and destitute of all Appearance of Good, perhaps for this only Reason, that we may assert our Liberty of Election. 'Tis certain that every one can do this, and he that does it, proves by an Experiment that he is free, and has a Power of pleasing himself in Election. Nor can he be said to be determined by the Judgment of the Understanding; for this reason is made by the itself, and may serve equally for every Election, since it is drawn from the Indifference of the Will itself: and he who does any thing upon a reason which is made by himself, and is indifferent to either Side, must be esteemed to act in the same manner as if he had done it without any reason at all. 'Tis evident therefore that we have this Power, and make use of the Appetites and Senses only as Spies and Informers; of Reason as a Counsellor; but that the Will is Master of itself, and creates pleasure for itself in Objects by Election.